



सत्यमेव जयते

विदेश मंत्रालय



विशेषाधिकृत निर्देश

**PRIVILEGED INSTRUCTIONS**

**Ministry of External Affairs  
REPUBLIC OF INDIA**



## भारत गणराज्य के विदेश मंत्रालय

MINISTRY OF EXTERNAL AFFAIRS  
REPUBLIC OF INDIA

### Privileged Instructions

#### Fundamental Principles

- India refuses to acquiesce to Chinese hegemony in Central Asia. With us being the most populous nation on the planet, with an economy growing faster than China's, and with a booming technology sector, deserves a rightful place as a leading nation in Asia. Thus, the delegation should prioritize blunting any initiative put forward at the summit by the PRC that would lead to China's dominance, or even deepening involvement in, Central Asia. China cannot become the de facto hegemon in the region. This is a **Red Line** for us.
- The Russian Federation has been a good friend to us, and the delegation is directed to openly support Russia's initiatives, unless otherwise directed by specific guidance in these instructions. However, a critical Red Line for New Delhi would be if Moscow were to significantly expand their military presence in the region, with their CSTO partners. It should be noted that Kazakhstan, Kyrgyzstan, and Tajikistan may all choose to follow Armenia's move to vacate their participation in the CSTO alliance. We believe nations should have the freedom to choose their own path, and should Russia seek to force any of these three nations to remain in the CSTO, against their will, it is a **Red Line** for us. The delegation should communicate all information about such a development back to the Foreign Ministry with all due haste and await further instructions
- The Central Asian nations offer us significant access to critical natural resources for our rapidly expanding technology sector. Uzbekistan and Kazakhstan are potential economic, and perhaps even security partners in the region. It is a **Red Line** for China to establish a bilateral trade or security arrangement with either Kazakhstan or Uzbekistan outside of a broader multilateral partnership among Asian nations.

#### Principle Negotiation Positions

These positions are to be presented openly and publicly to all attendees. However, the delegation should pursue the specific items outlined below, either bilaterally or multilaterally, and should ensure India's red lines are not crossed in any diplomatic agreements that might be presented, discussed, or aggressively pursued.

- We are strongly in favor of the peaceful, comprehensive, and just settlement of the border disputes. The delegation is equally amenable to finding solutions to the challenge of sustainable, fair, and equitable agreements regarding water resources.
- We welcome the partnership with the PRC and the Russia in assisting the Central Asian nations in any manner the nations may deem supportive to the two challenges of border security and water resources.
- Being the largest democracy on the planet, we are an ardent supporter of the power of representative government and urges all partners in the region to continue to observe

and pursue the reforms needed to improve the lives of everyone in the region under such governance rules.

These positions are to be held throughout the summit but are not to be presented openly to any other delegation unless otherwise directed.

- The delegation is to undermine all Chinese initiatives that would place China at the center of, or in a strong leadership position, in the Central Asian region.
- While being supportive of the Russian Federation's positions, the delegation is also directed to maintain vigilance on the Russian delegation's efforts to reinsert themselves into primacy in Central Asia—a position they abandoned when the Soviet Union collapsed.
- Tajikistan, soon after gaining independence, was a solid partner to us. The delegation should seek to reinvigorate this relationship with all haste, including offering the Tajik delegation incentives in the areas of free trade, economic assistance, security assistance, or diplomatic assistance as an ally and friend to the Tajik peoples. The delegation should openly back the Tajikistan delegation's proposals unless they wildly differ from the guidance stated herein. If that is the case, immediately contact the Minister of External Affairs to receive specific guidance.

### Delegation Instructions

***Ensure periodic reports, requests for further guidance, or clarifications to the instructions herein are submitted to the office of the Minister of External Affairs.***

General: The delegation will work closely with and support the UN Special Representative of the Secretary-General's efforts to mediate this crisis. The delegation is directed to collect all available information about the negotiating positions of the other countries at the summit. Where possible, ascertain the other nation's flexible areas and try to bend the countries toward agreeing to Indian interests. The end goal of this summit for India is to reestablish influence, reduce tensions, and set conditions allowing for subsequent bilateral engagement between the Indian Foreign Ministry and the Central Asian nations to further India's interests to our north.

### **PEOPLE'S REPUBLIC OF CHINA**

Box out the PRC at every turn. But do so cautiously and thoughtfully. Do not openly argue with, attack, or otherwise openly disagree with the Chinese delegation's positions. Rather, be subtle and undermine the PRC's efforts through private, bilateral talks with the four Central Asian nations in attendance. Do not allow the PRC to succeed in isolating us even more through their Belt and Road Initiative (BRI). The BRI is a direct threat to our long-term economic wellbeing and should be challenged at every turn—again, subtly. It is likely the Chinese delegation will have at least one operative from the Ministry of State Security embedded within their team. If you can identify that person, it is acceptable to openly challenge the Chinese delegation for having a "spy" within their negotiating team, undermining the very spirit of the open and honest dialogue each nation agreed to pursue at the UN-sponsored summit.

## **KAZAKHSTAN**

The Research and Analysis Wing (RAW) indicate Kazakhstan is seeking to withdraw from both the CSTO and the Eurasian Economic Zone, but as Kazakhstan shares a lengthy border with Russia, and the Russian Federation has demonstrated a pathological fixation on their near abroad, Kazakhstan is in a difficult position. The Indian delegation is directed to be openly supportive of the Kazakh delegation's initiatives, policy proposals, and recommendations to solve the two major crises being addressed at the summit. Privately, be direct, and be supportive of the Kazakhs' ideas, and use that alignment to dive deeply into Kazakhstan's plans. Discover any intentions regarding the CSTO and Eurasian Economic Zone. If the Kazakh government plans to withdraw from one or both larger affiliations, our delegation is directed to offer the possibility of a Kazakhstan-India security agreement, the details of which would be worked out later. Similarly, the delegation should offer economic opportunities in the form of free trade agreements that equitably support development in both nations. Assess Kazakhstan's need for new weapons systems to defend their sovereignty. Acquire the framework desired by the Kazakh delegation for follow-on, in-depth discussions with the Indian Foreign and Defense ministries. Pass all available information to the Minister of External Affairs for analysis and guidance.

## **KYRGYZSTAN**

We have very little relationship with Kyrgyzstan. Nevertheless, the delegation is authorized and directed to build a functioning relationship with the Kyrgyz delegation with a goal of winning their support for our positions and initiatives. It may be possible to play our friendship with Tajikistan as a gambit to serving as an honest broker with Kyrgyzstan, and perhaps as justification to embrace a Kyrgyzstan-India partnership to create more opportunities for open and honest dialogue between those two Central Asian nations. Like other Central Asian nations, their military equipment is outdated and of Soviet design and origin. RAW assesses that the Kyrgyz military is ready to look for new weapons platforms and systems and we are ready to export many of our capabilities to both old and new friends. Acquire information as to the Kazakhs' needs in this area and communicate that information back to the Foreign Ministry.

## **RUSSIA**

Russia has long been a friend to the Republic of India. Sadly, the nation has pursued irresponsible foreign and domestic policies for many years now, causing the country to slip into irrelevance. The delegation should be publicly supportive of the Russian delegation's positions, but in a way that doesn't place India in direct alliance with Russia. Rather, the delegation should offer thoughtful, supportive statements that can be seen as encouraging the peaceful, long-term resolutions sought at the summit. Russian ideas can be "interesting," or even "very thoughtful," but do not publicly back any Russian plans until you've communicated the specifics back to the Foreign Ministry for analysis and guidance has been provided. The delegation is free to discuss Russian technical assistance and even additional arms sales from Russia, but, again, gather all pertinent information and relay it to the Foreign Ministry for assessment.

## TAJIKISTAN

The delegation should seek to expand our influence inside Tajikistan, even if it means supplanting Russia's initiatives inside Tajikistan. Reestablishing air base privileges with the Tajik Air Force would be optimal. Short of that option, combined training exercises between the Tajik Air Force and the Indian Air Force, carried out at least annually, and from air bases inside Tajikistan, is a core objective to be pursued at this summit. The delegation is empowered to offer incentives to the Tajik delegation to affect this outcome. Broader Tajik security support is also a core element of the delegation's assignment. Ascertain Tajikistan's needs in this area, communicate those needs back to the Minister of External Affairs, and be prepared to negotiate with the Tajik delegation in bilateral-only dialogue regarding economic or security incentives that help to reestablish an ongoing presence inside Tajikistan. Tajikistan may choose to leave the Russian-led CSTO. It is possible they may choose to apply to join the Eurasian Economic Union. The delegation is afforded the freedom to ascertain Tajikistan's motives and plans in this area, and to offer economic incentives to shift toward trade with us. Further, technical assistance for any economic, security, infrastructure, medical, or other pursuit is also on the table. Of particular interest would be providing Indian assistance to improve democratic practices in Tajikistan, should the Tajik delegation be interested in learning more. Finally, Indian arms are for sale, and Tajikistan is desperately in need of affordable, maintainable, capable weapons platforms and systems. The delegation is directed to assess Tajikistan's needs in these areas. Report back your findings and await further guidance.

## UZBEKISTAN

Uzbekistan and India do not currently have a significant economic, security, or diplomatic links. Regardless, they are a young and growing population, and they are rapidly liberalizing their country. Young Uzbeks are likely interested in career opportunities, and we offer copious high-paying positions in the tech sector, among many other sectors. While security partnerships are unlikely with Uzbekistan, economic partnerships may prove lucrative for both sides. The delegation is given wide latitude in assessing the Uzbek delegation's interests and needs across the full spectrum of the tools of national power. Report back to the Foreign Ministry and await further guidance on any initiatives which the delegation sees as possible win/win options for the India-Uzbekistan relationship.

**There may be times when the Minister of External Affairs is unable to respond immediately to your communication. Under those circumstances, the delegation should proceed as directed in this guidance.**